

tubing but they might bring problems such as plasticising and they can be difficult to route within the chassis. If you're cooling both your CPU and graphics card, then you'll be dealing with a lot of tubing. It becomes more cluttered, even though it might look amazing, and it might start causing airflow problems in the PC case. There won't be much of a hindrance if you're cooling just one component. In such a case, it would be best to go for thinner tubing. On a more general note, you should opt for that diameter for which all the necessary parts are easily available.

Cutting and bending

After buying all the tubing and fittings, it's time to start the tedious work of cutting and bending the tubes. You must have already planned out your loop design. If you haven't, this would be the right time. You need to install all your components so that when you're measuring the length of the tubes, you will have a more accurate idea. You should mark the tubes using rulers. Then you can start cutting them down. If you're using soft tubing, you can use either normal blades or pipe cutters to do a cleaner job. For hard tubing,



You can use a normal pipe cutter for PVC soft tubing

you will need to use hacksaws or hard tube cutters for a precision cut. After cutting hard tubes, the edges might not be uniform or hold chippings. You can use a reamer to even them out before attaching them to the fittings otherwise they might leak. Make sure that you wet the end before spinning it around the reamer. As a beginner, you must be careful not to cut the tubing too short.

To bend a hard tube, you will need to first heat the tube until it reaches its glass-transition temperature (the temperature at which the tube softens) and then bend at the appropriate angle. For this, you will need a heat gun and probably mandrels to guide the bending. Before you fire the heat gun to the tube, you will need a silicon insert. This cord enters the pipe and ensures that the tube doesn't collapse when you're bending it. They usually tend to be heat resistant so don't worry about it deforming and getting stuck inside. You will need to match the diameter of the insert with the ID of the tube.

Place the heat gun on a surface so that it's pointing upwards and set it to the medium setting. Hold the tube at a distance of about 5cm and